

FIELD LIBRARY / FULL FIELD GUIDE

Hurricane

NATURAL HAZARDS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Check your evacuation zone and the current order. If told to evacuate, leave before conditions deteriorate. If staying outside an evacuation zone, shelter inside a sturdy building away from windows; storm surge and inland flooding can be deadly even far from the storm center.

Do now.

**Check your zone**

01

Read local evacuation and storm-surge instructions for your address, not just the forecast track.

**Leave when directed**

02

Use official routes to a destination outside the hazard area. Bring medications, identification, pets and phone power.

**Shelter for wind**

03

If the building is safe and evacuation is not required, stay in an interior room away from windows during strong winds.

**Watch for water**

04

Keep out of flooded roads and basements. Follow separate flash-flood warnings and move to safer higher ground when necessary.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Before roads become unsafe, move out of surge-prone areas using a route and destination you have checked. If already trapped by wind or water, stay in the safest intact interior space available, with flood risk in mind. Do not travel during the calm eye.

Watch for.

A calm eye is not an all-clear. Do not base flood safety on the wind category.

People & practical needs.

Account for children, older people, pets and anyone who needs assistance before moving. Keep shoes, medicines and a torch in the shelter area. Decide who helps whom and who carries the essential supplies; do not send a lone child to retrieve items. For this situation, brief every person on the first action: check your zone. Agree who will manage children, pets or mobility needs while that action happens. A calm eye is not an all-clear. Do not base flood safety on the wind category.

Keep essentials within reach.

For hurricane, prioritize only items needed for the first action and the fallback: Before roads become unsafe, move out of surge-prone areas using a route and destination you have checked. If already trapped by wind or water, stay in the safest intact interior space available, with flood risk in mind. Do not travel during the calm eye. Keep the relevant checklist and contact information within reach. Equipment retrieval must not delay the protective step.

Next decisions.

Expect extended outages. Store water, protect documents and charge devices before the storm. Return only after officials allow reentry.

First decision: Check your zone

Read local evacuation and storm-surge instructions for your address, not just the forecast track. Decide which person can carry this out immediately and what would prevent it in your current location. Do not delay the protective step to complete a household worksheet.

When the original plan fails

Before roads become unsafe, move out of surge-prone areas using a route and destination you have checked. If already trapped by wind or water, stay in the safest intact interior space available, with flood risk in mind. Do not travel during the calm eye. Reassess the next available location or resource using the warning signs in this guide; do not assume a promised service is operating.

Before changing location

A calm eye is not an all-clear. Do not base flood safety on the wind category. Check the actual route and the needs of the person who will have the most difficulty moving. A destination is not confirmed until access and conditions have been checked.

Questions in the field.

What matters before collecting supplies?

Check your evacuation zone and the current order. If told to evacuate, leave before conditions deteriorate. If staying outside an evacuation zone, shelter inside a sturdy building away from windows; storm surge and inland flooding can be deadly even far from the storm center. Collect items only if doing so does not delay this action.

What should another household member do?

Use a second person to handle communication or dependents while the first carries out the immediate action. For hurricane, keep the specific hazard in view: A calm eye is not an all-clear. Do not base flood safety on the wind category.

What should be written down?

Record when the situation changed, what action was taken and what remains uncertain. For this situation, start with: Watch for water. Keep out of flooded roads and basements. Follow separate flash-flood warnings and move to safer higher ground when necessary. Keep personal notes private; they are not submitted to Osprey Zero.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

NEXT ACTION / PERSON RESPONSIBLE

Sources & limits.

Civilian educational guidance. Linked references may use U.S. emergency systems; local warning methods, laws, services and conditions differ.

Source-linked editorial guidance. Not independent clinical or specialist certification. Training and product-specific instructions remain essential.

Hurricane · official guidance

<https://www.ready.gov/hurricanes>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/hurricane/>

Content updated 2026-10-02. Saved guidance cannot provide live alerts.